

Firearms Trace Data: New Jersey - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in New Jersey in Calendar Year 2023

4,619

Firearm Types with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	3,355
Revolvers	498
Rifles	437
Shotguns	269
Machinegun Conversion Devices	22
Derringers	14
Machineguns	13
Other*	11

* Other includes Unknown Types, Any Other Weapons, Combinations, Silencers and a Receiver/Frame.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	2,082
.40 Cal	420
.22 Cal	355
.380 Cal	283

.45 Cal	257
.38 Cal	221
12GA	213
.357 Cal	101
5.56mm	92
.32 Cal	88

NOTE: There were 423 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 84 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	1,897
Found Firearm	1,163
Weapon Offense	310
Firearm Under Investigation	286
Aggravated Assault	144
Health - Safety	141
Dangerous Drugs	102
Family Offense	101
Property Crimes	68
Threat	53
Homicide	52

NOTE: There were 302 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

New Jersey	667
Pennsylvania	532
Georgia	393
North Carolina	267
Virginia	260
South Carolina	212
Florida	161
Ohio	81
Texas	62
Alabama	53
Delaware	51
Tennessee	40
New York	38
Indiana	37
West Virginia	34

NOTE: An additional 33 states, the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico accounted for 285 other traces. The source state was identified in 3,173 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	109
3 Months to Under 7 Months	116
7 Months to Under 1 Year	140
1 Year to Under 2 Years	402
2 Years to Under 3 Years	436
3 Years and Over	1,962

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 New Jersey Average Time-to-Crime: **9.37 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	224
18 to 21	475
22 to 24	312
25 to 30	552
31 to 40	847
41 to 50	464
Over 50	514

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 New Jersey Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Newark	462
Camden	406
Trenton	287
Paterson	208
Atlantic City	142
Jersey City	125
Elizabeth	111
Vineland	107
East Orange	95
Bayonne	74

NOTE: There were 374 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,599 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for three traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of New Jersey. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to New Jersey.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a New Jersey Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024